settlements are organized clan-wise and they collectively own the village land. Members of the clan can freely cultivate, hunt, fish, gather fruit and firewood on village land. The Mishmis share a physical boundary with Tibet, but other than trade, they had little to do with their northern neighbours who over the ages were quite content to leave them alone.

Previously known as the Meyor, the Zekhring inhabit the Walong and Kibithu circles of the region and have a small population that even today barely touches the four-figure mark. Originally from Tibet they fled their homeland in the wake of the floods that devastated the Chamdo region and also to escape persecution by the Tibetan authorities. Migrating into the Lohit Valley at the beginning of the twentieth century they faced fierce opposition from the Mishmi. Unable to withstand the incessant attacks both in the Dri and Mathun valleys, they extended allegiance to the major clans, paying tributes to their heads. The Imu River was decided as the boundary between the two communities.

In the northeastern corner of the Lohit Frontier Division, the Diphu-la (16,850 feet) is situated some eight kilometres south of the India-Burma-Tibet tri-junction. While in the Kameng Division there was some debate on whether the McMahon Line ran along the Thagla Ridge or the Tsangdhar Ridge east of Khenzemane to the tri-junction with Bhutan, there was never any ambiguity in the case of the Lohit Frontier Division. However, in what was clearly a manufactured controversy, after 1959 the Chinese started claiming that the Dhipu-la itself was the tri-junction. According to this claim line, the crest of the Ndap range branching from Diphu-la then becomes a disputed feature. This spur acts as a dividing line between the valleys of Di Chu and Sat Ti Chu. By laying claim to the crest of the highest range from the northern side and by including Diphu-la in Greater China, approximately 740 square kilometres then become disputed as the Ndap range extends up to Walong.

The entire Lohit Frontier Division is bounded by the Assam Himalayas to its north and east. The McMahon Line running along the watershed divides the Lat Ti Chu on the Tibetan side and the Di Chu on the NEFA side of the crest line. From the Diphu-la, extending southwest and then southeast is the Patkoi Range, a mountain wall that separates the Lohit Division from Burma. To the west, another mountain range acts as the boundary between the Miji Mishmi and the Idu Mishmi, the latter residing primarily in the